ALINE-PRISCILLIA MESSI

PHD CANDIDATE
NYU PSYCHOLOGY

CONTACT

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Address: 10 Washington Pl., 6th Floor, 10003, NY, USA

EDUCATION

2022 - present
New York University
PhD Cognition and Perception, Psychology

2018 - 2021
Leiden University
B.A. in Linguistics, Cum Laude with honors (GPA 8.5/10)

RESEARCH POSITIONS

2022 - present
New York University
PhD Candidate in Neuroscience of Language Group
Supervisor: Dr. Liina Pylkkanen

2020 - 2021
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics
Research assistant in Language and Computation in Neural Systems Group
Honors thesis: "Gain shift in the nested hierarchies of language"
Supervisors: Dr. Yiya Chen (Leiden University) and Dr. Sanne ten Oever (Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics)

2020 - 2022
Semantic Universals in the Modal Domain (MODuni)
Data analyst for French data

March 2020 - August 2020
eLaw Center for Law and Digital Technologies
Research assistant for Law and Healthcare Robots Project (Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Research Grant)

April 2020 - July 2020
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics
Research Intern in Language and Computation in Neural Systems Group

HONORS, AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS

Dean's Conference Fund Grant, New York University, $500, 2025
Social Sector Leadership Diversity Fellow, New York University, 2023 - 2024
Travel Award, Society for the Neurobiology of Language, 2023
MacCracken Fellowship, New York University, $75,000/yr, 2022-2026
Engberg Award, Cognition and Perception, New York University, $1000, 2022
ECHO Centre for Diversity Policy, ECHO Award Nominee Leiden University, 2021
Humanities Honors College, Leiden University, 2020-2021
Propaedeutic diploma in Linguistics with Summa Cum Laude, Leiden University, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Messi, A., Bhuyain, A., & Pylkkänen, L. (2026). **Temporal constraints on the neural signatures of narrative processing**. eLife, 15:RP112198. DOI: 10.7554/eLife.112198.1

Messi, A. & Pylkkänen, L. (2025). **Tracking neural correlates of contextualized meanings with representational similarity analysis**. Journal of Neuroscience, 45(19). DOI: 10.1523/JNEUROSCI.0409-24.2025

TEACHING

Summer 2026
Adjunct professor
Cognition

Fall 2025
Teaching Assistant
Cognitive Neuroscience

2023 - 2024
Course Assistant
Intro to Data Literacy, Lab in Developmental Psychology

July 2023
Instructor: Neuroscience Outreach Group at NYU x College Career Lab
Taught: Introduction to Neuroanatomy; Learning and Memory

TALKS, PRESENTATIONS

September 2026
Poster: Does shared lived experience shape neural responses to language?
Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Geneva, Switzerland

January 2026
Talk: The Influence of Structure and Speed on MEG Responses to Narratives
Alpine Brain Imaging Meeting, Champéry, Switzerland

November 2025
Talk: 4th Year Talk
Psychology Department, New York University

September 2025
Poster: Right Hemisphere Sensitivity to Structure and Speed
Authors: **Messi Aline-Priscillia**, Pylkkänen Liina
Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Washington D.C., USA

April 2025
Presentation: Representational Similarity Analysis
Neuroscience of Language Joint Methods meetings, New York University

November 2024
Panelist: Pathways to a doctoral degree
GSAS Master's College and Wasserman Center, New York University

November 2023
Invited Talk: Tracking word representations in MEG using Representational Similarity Analysis.
NeuLab, New York University

October 2023
Poster: Tracking word representations in MEG using Representational Similarity Analysis.
Authors**: Messi Aline-Priscillia,** Pylkkänen Liina
Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille, France

MENTORSHIP

July 2026 - present
Ali Bimani
Psychology Masters student, New York University
Current research assistant for dissertation project

June 2024 - September 2025
Abir Bhuyain
Junior - Language and Mind major (Pre-med) New York University
Former research assistant for dissertation project, now Lab Manager

November 2025 - July 2026
Nadia Hoffman
Sophomore - Language and Mind major, New York University
Former research assistant for dissertation project, now Honors student

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2024 - Summer 2026
Methods Meetings Co-Organizer
Neuroscience of Language Lab, New York University

2023 - 2024
Cognition and Perception Social Chair
Psychology, New York University

June 2024 - present
Grant Coordinator
Bed-Stuy Clothes Swap

Summer 2023
Science on the Ballot Team Member
March for Science NYC

May 2023
Poster session Judge
27th Annual NYU Masters Psychology Research Conference 2023

Summer 2022
Content Coordinator
Psychology Summer Research Program, New York University

SKILLS

Software
Praat, SPSS, Microsoft Office Suite, PsychoPy, Audacity, Eprime, Gorilla, Qualtrics

Programming
Python, Matlab, R, basic HTML and javascript

Marketing and Design
Illustrator, Sketch, Invision, Wordpress, SEO optimization (Yoast), CRM, Google Ad Words

Languages
Native in French and English, Advanced Spanish